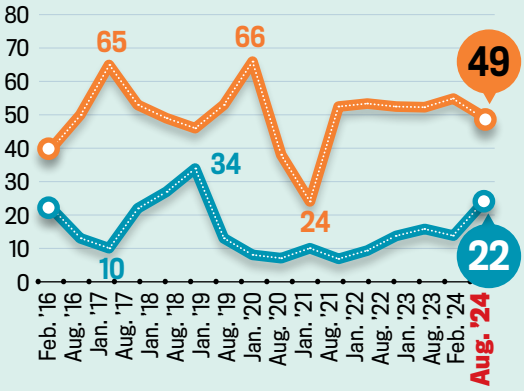
Q. Who is best suited to be India's next prime minister, Narendra Modi or Rahul Gandhi?



All figures rounded off; rest, others & DK/ CS

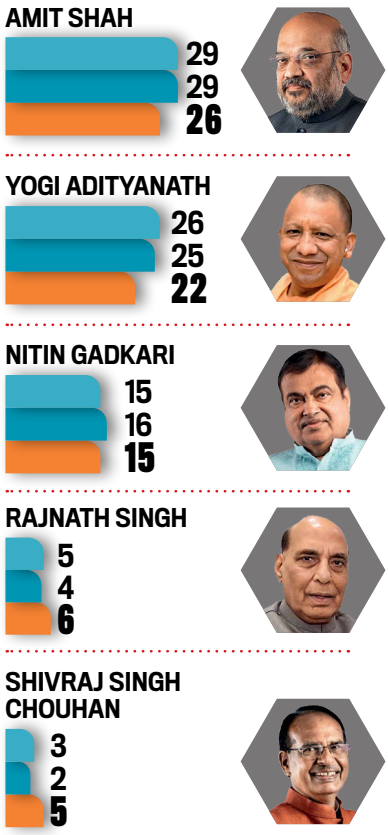
For the first time since Jan. 2022, the support for Narendra Modi has dropped below 50 per cent



42%

of the OBC respondents—highest among all caste groups—see the Lok Sabha election result as a vote for continuity of the BJP government and PM Modi

Q. Who is best suited to succeed Modi as the BJP's prime ministerial candidate?



All figures in % and rounded off; rest, others & DK/ CS; those with less than 5% support not considered

Modi's performance as outstanding sees a fall of 7.3 percentage points. But despite this loss in Modi's sheen, he is still regarded as the country's best bet for prime minister

Modi. In the Opposition sweepstakes too, Rahul has surged ahead with 32.3 per cent, with the gap between him and Mamata Banerjee, Arvind Kejriwal and Akhilesh Yadav growing to over 25 percentage points. However, like for Modi, there is a caveat for Rahul's rise as well: the Congress remains a distant challenger to the BJP, and it is the regional partners in INDIA, such as the Trinamool Congress (TMC) in West Bengal, the Samajwadi Party in Uttar Pradesh and the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) in Tamil Nadu that are shoring up the Opposition numbers. Among the BJP leaders, Shah manages to retain his lead over Yogi Adityanath to be the party's prime ministerial candidate. Though, to Yogi Adityanath's credit, he once again emerges as the most popular chief minister nationally. In terms of popularity within the home state, we have a new winner, Sikkim's two-time CM Prem Singh Tamang whose party SKM recently swept the assembly poll. Interestingly, no sitting Congress chief minister figures in the 10 most popular CMs in their home states.

For the BJP, the MOTN offers no salve for the losses it incurred in the big states, which led to their overall tally slipping under the majority mark in the Lok Sabha election. In Uttar